Republic of the Philippines
PARTIDO STATE UNIVERSITY
Camarines Sur

August 23, 2022

RAUL G. BRADECINA, Ph.D.
SUC President III

Attention: MS. CHONA MASALUNGA
Human Resources Management Office

Dear **President Bradecina**,

Greetings!

The undersigned is the Partido State University's Project Coordinator for the Commission On Higher Education-funded collaborative research project under the "Leading the Advancement of Knowledge in Agriculture and Sciences (LAKAS) Program" ("LAKAS Program"), entitled, **Phytochemical characterization of macroalgae for food and high value products (PhycoPRO)**, led by Dr. Michael Y. Roleda, Dr. William H. Gerwick, Dr. Irene B. Rodriquez, and Dr. Lena S. Gerwick of the Marine Science Institute, University of the Philippines Diliman.

As proposed and approved, there is a need to hire two (2) University Research Assistants (URA 1 – SG 12) with a monthly salary of ₱33,130.00 (annual salary of ₱397, 560.00) for two years (Please see the attached PhycoPRO notarized Research Funding Agreement).

After receiving several applications and interviews, I have been able to select and thereby recommend hiring one of the two needed URAs.

I would like to recommend the hiring of MS. ELLUNA JANE J. BIGCAS as the *second* URA 1 to be hired from July 1, 2022 until June 30, 2024. Herewith are the pertinent documents relative to his application.

The main responsibilities of the URA shall include:

- seaweed collection and identification based on molecular-assisted taxonomy,
- characterization of environmental conditions where seaweeds thrive,
- data analysis, and
- manuscript publication

She is also expected to perform the following:

- Assist in the documentation and photo-documentation of samples;
- Assist the proponent in preparing the component technical and financial reports;
- Participate in all meetings called by the proponent;
- Participate in the orientation/training of the research assistants on selected survey methods and sampling techniques;
- Assist in obtaining the required collection and research permits;
- Assist in determining the exact sites to be surveyed prior to field investigation and specific; location coordinates, access routes and directions to the should be well understood before entering the field;
- Assist in contacting all appropriate authorities prior to the commencement of survey activities;
- Assist in ensuring that all field equipment needed to complete the survey are assembled;
- Secure and keepsafe the collected data;
- Assist in preparing the final research project report;
- Assist in the drafting and finalization of the research paper manuscript and publication;
- Display good work ethics and resourcefulness;
- Conform with the administrative and procedures of the office;
- Display positive leadership;
- Perform other related functions;

Thank you very much in anticipation for your approval.

Sincerely,

MICHAEL A. CLORES, PhD
Project Leader

Recommending Approval:

LUISA M. LANCISO
Director, Research and Development

PATRICIA M. CANDELARIA
VP for Research, Extension and Knowledge Management

Certified Availability of Fund
Trust Fund
July 1 – Dec 31, 2022
₱ 33, 130.00

AMALIA O. OCAMPO
Budget Officer

Approved:

RAUL G. BRADECINA, PhD
SUC President III